

Assessing Science Use in AI Policymaking: An AI Pipeline

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State AI Policymaking is Rapidly Picking Up

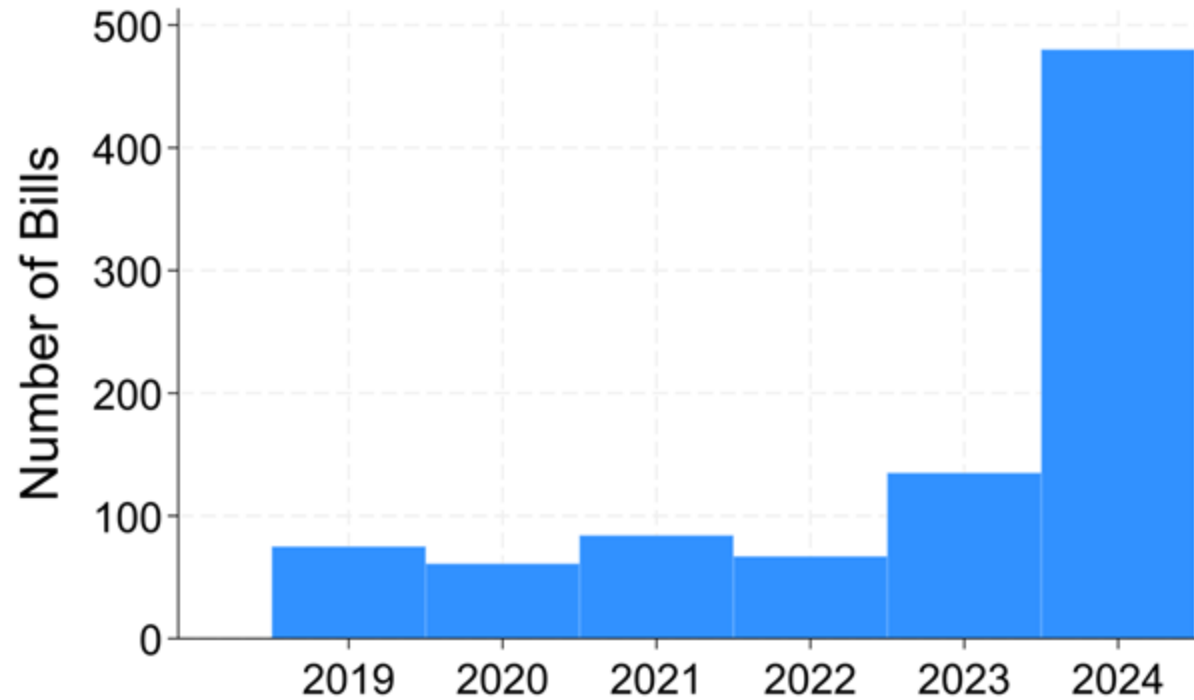
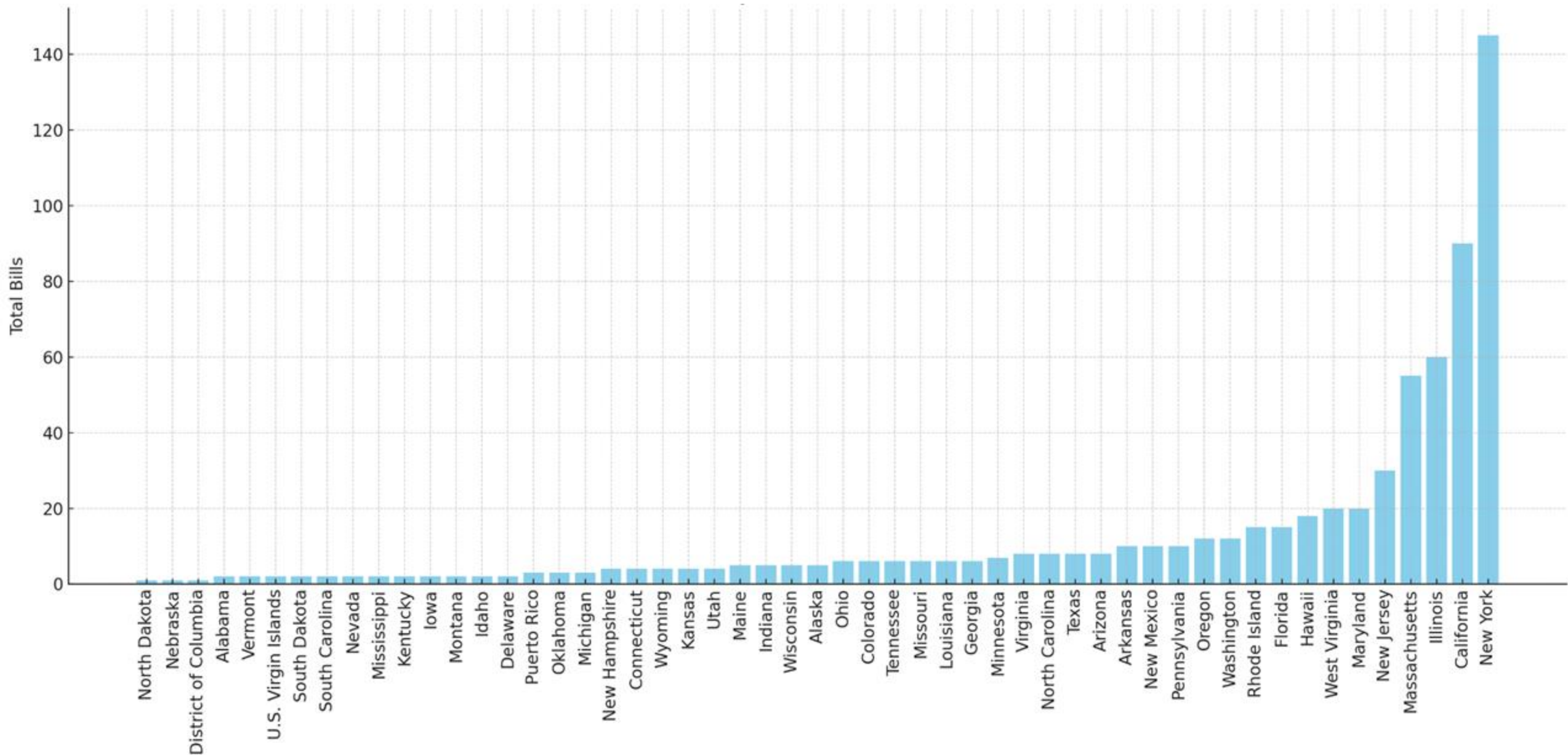


Figure 1: Counts of bills on AI proposed in state legislatures, 2019–2024. Source: National Conference of State Legislatures.

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AI Bills by State (2019-2024)



Project Overview

- **Objective:** Develop and apply an AI-driven pipeline for assessing scientific evidence for claims in policymaking documents.
- **Approach:**
 - Extract evidentiary claims from policymaking documents with Notebook LM
 - Use web-connected LLM (GPT-5) to collect claim-relevant scientific references
- **Case:** Claims in AI-related Press Releases by CA State Legislators

Why CA AI Policy?

- AI policy is emerging fast; involves high technical uncertainty.
- We study how scientific evidence enters AI policymaking.
- California is a high-activity and high-profile case.

Tracking Evidence in Legislative press releases

Assemblymember Bauer-Kahan Introduces Bill to Eliminate Bias in AI Decision-making

AB 2930 prohibits bias in Automated Decision Tools (ADTs).

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE:

Thursday, February 15, 2024

Sacramento, CA – Today, Chair of the California State Assembly Privacy and Consumer Protection Committee, Assemblymember Bauer-Kahan (D-Orinda) introduced a bill that will pave the way for common sense regulations on artificial intelligence (AI). AB 2930 requires developers and users to mitigate and assess automated decision tools (ADTs) that make consequential decisions, and is supported by Microsoft and Workday.

"Algorithms are already making decisions about our lives, and there's no check on the bias. These hidden forces are embedding discrimination further into our system and it's unacceptable," said **Assemblymember Bauer-Kahan**. "AB 2930 continues our work to ensure that AI fulfills its promises of progress and does not drag us backwards with biased results."

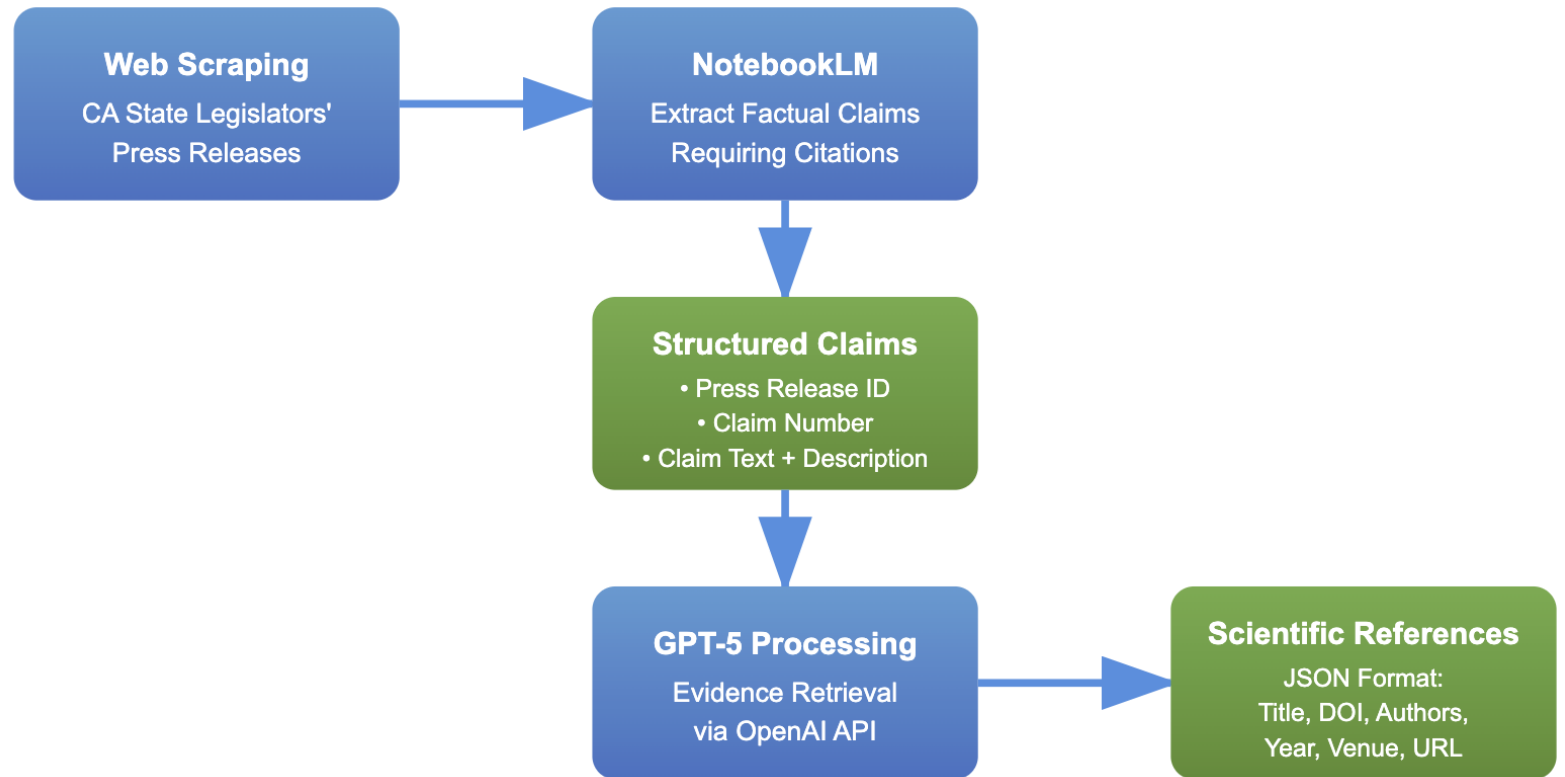
"Microsoft is proud to support AB 2930. This legislation will help develop strong legal guardrails for Automated Decision Tools and empower communities across California with safe and transparent AI solutions. We look forward to working with Assemblymember Rebecca Bauer-Kahan to move this bill forward and continue advancing legislation that aligns with Microsoft's values," said **Robyn Hines, Senior Director of State Government Affairs for Microsoft**.

AB 2930 requires developers and users of ADTs to conduct and record an impact assessment including the intended use, the makeup of the data, and the rigor of the statistical analysis. The data reported must also include an analysis of potential adverse impact on the basis of race, color, ethnicity, sex, religion, age, national origin, or any other classification protected by state law.

Automated Decision Tools are being used to assess eligibility for a benefit or penalty. These systems have been traditionally used for credit decisions, however usage has expanded to employment screening, insurance eligibility, and health care decisions. ADTs have been found to exhibit biases and consequently have resulted in discriminatory impacts and harm to marginalized communities. For example, a study published in *Science* showed that a clinical algorithm used across hospitals for determining patient care was racially biased against Black patients.

Policy-to-Science Pipeline

- **NotebookLM Query:**
“Extract up to 10 claims related to AI/ emergent technology from this press release for which, if you were writing a scientific paper, you would need to have references.”
- **GPT Query:** “Task: Provide up to 10 scientific references relevant to the claim...”



Evidence Assessment in GPT-5

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ChatGPT 5 Thinking ▾

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see the science paper referenced in this document. find the citation for the paper. make sure it is a valid reference.

Thought for 1m 20s

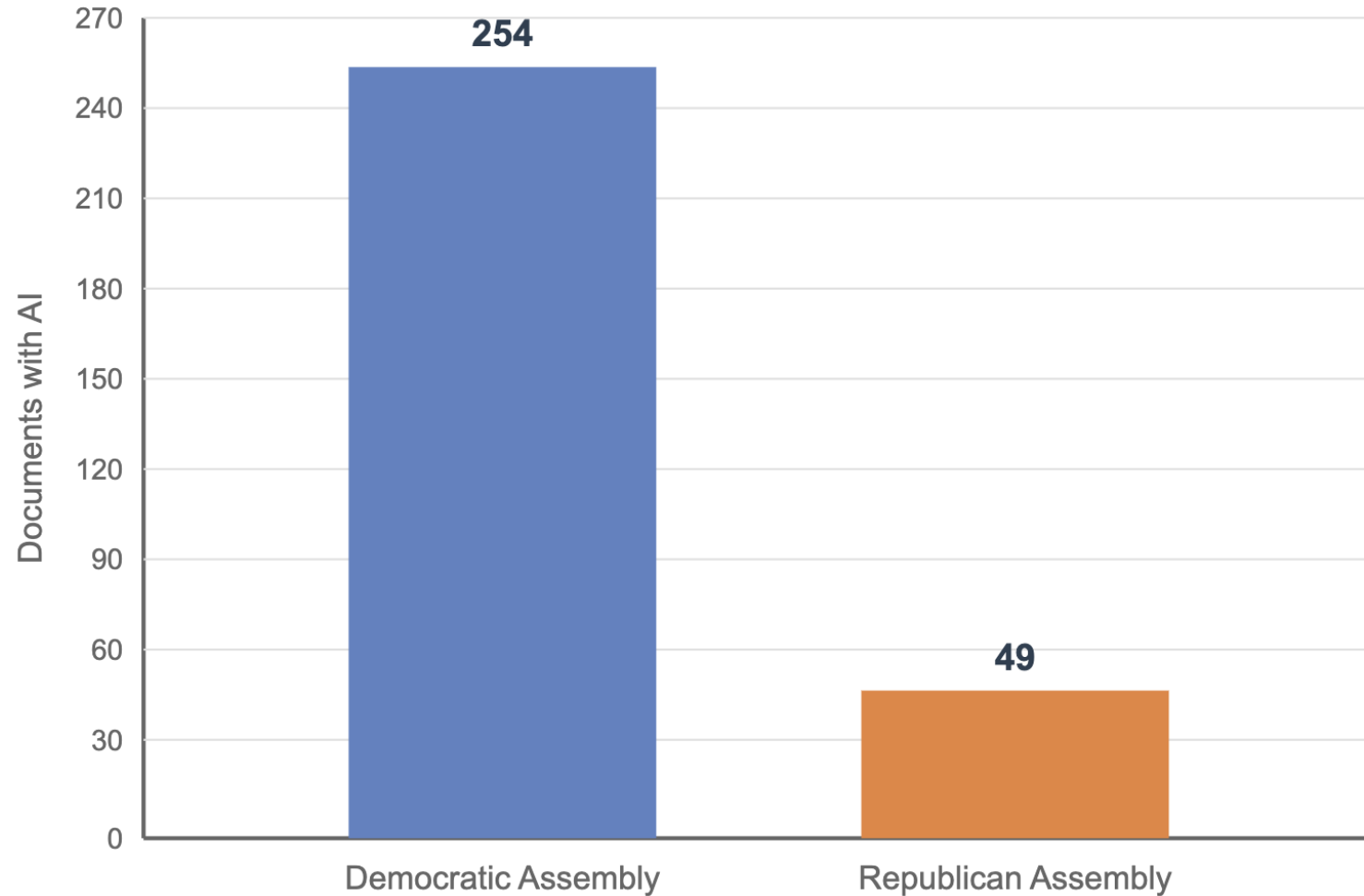
Here's the Science paper the release is referring to:

APA

Obermeyer, Z., Powers, B., Vogeli, C., & Mullainathan, S. (2019). *Dissecting racial bias in an algorithm used to manage the health of populations*. *Science*, 366(6464), 447–453. DOI: 10.1126/science.aax2342.

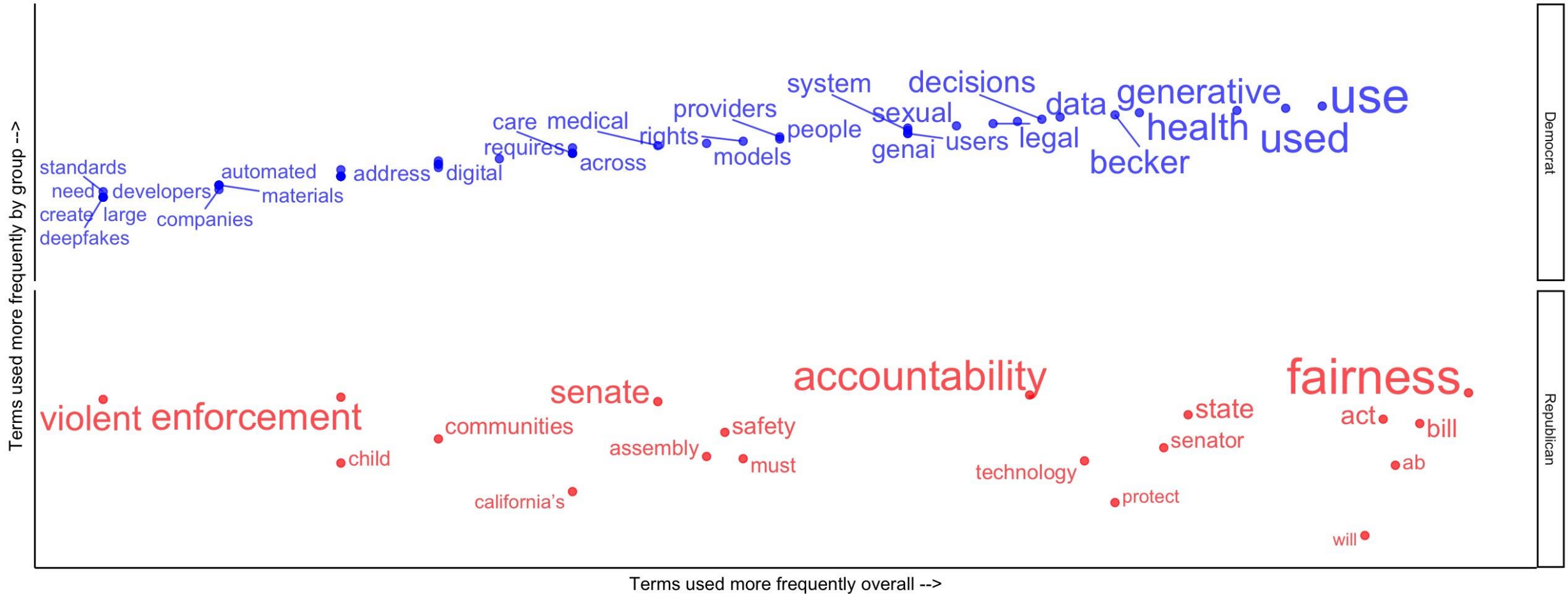
Science +1

AI-related Press Releases by Party

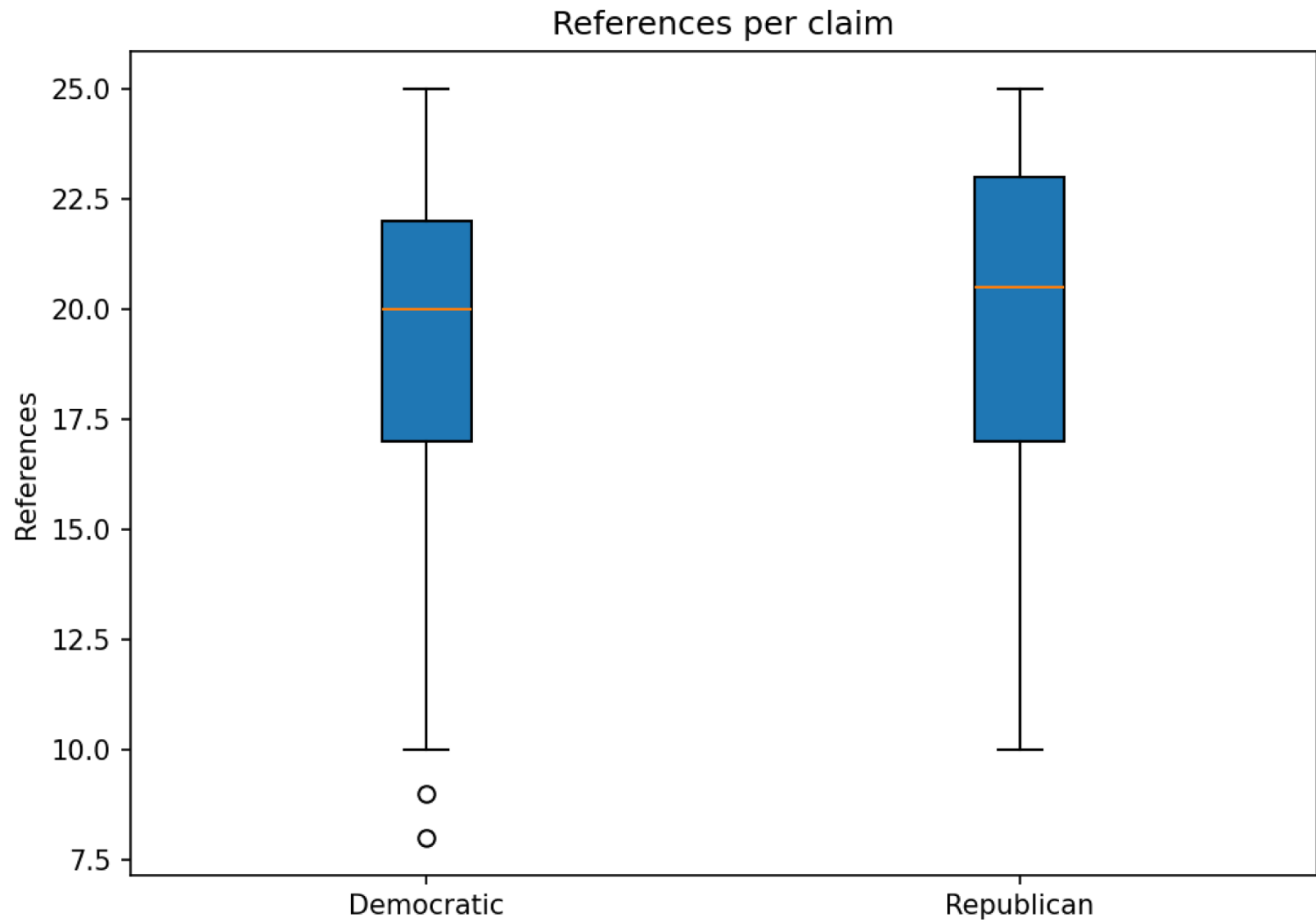


Party Differences in AI Policy Discussion

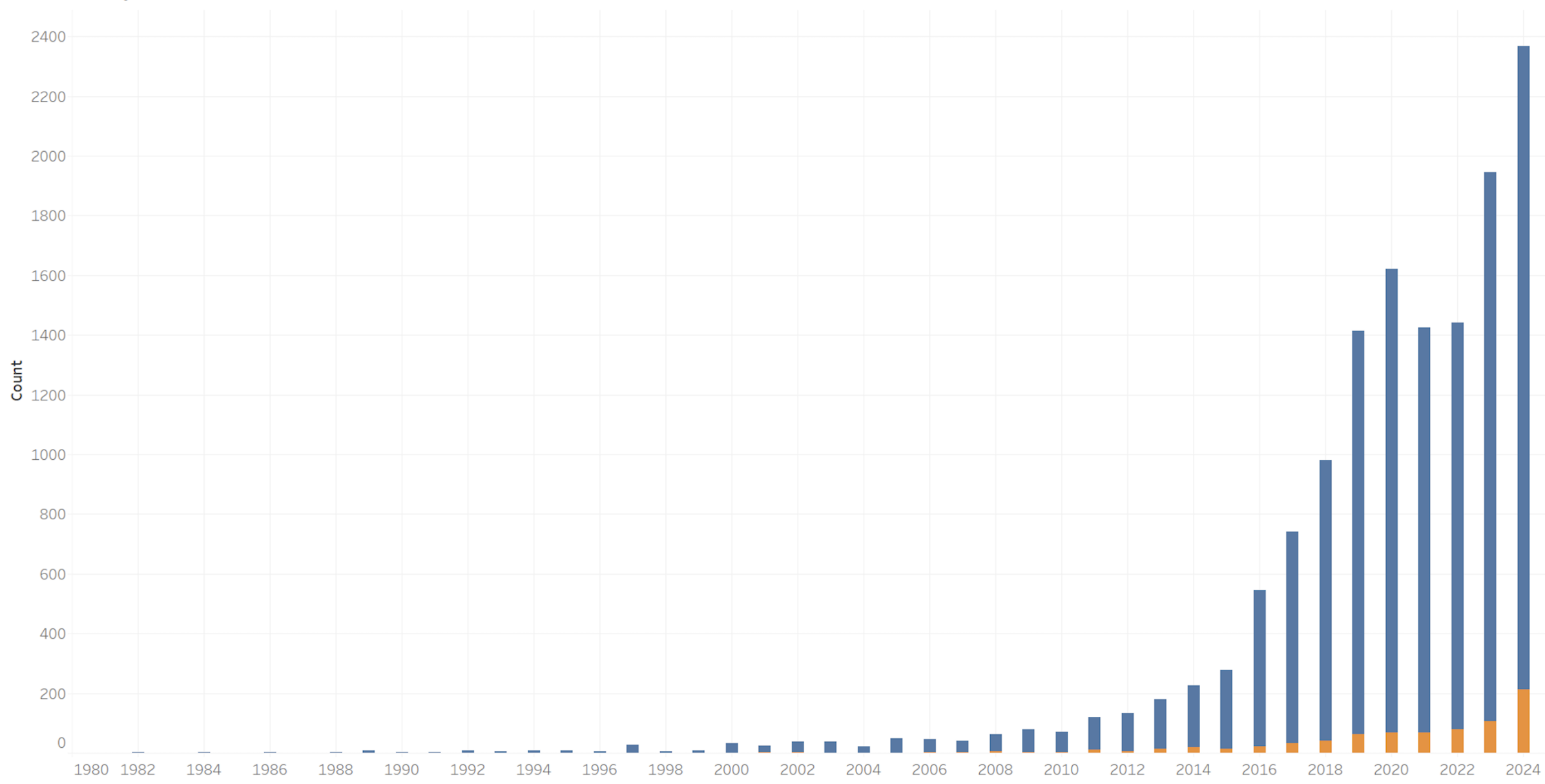
Comparison of Terms by Groups



Group-specific terms are ordered by Fightin' Words statistic (Monroe, et al. 2008)

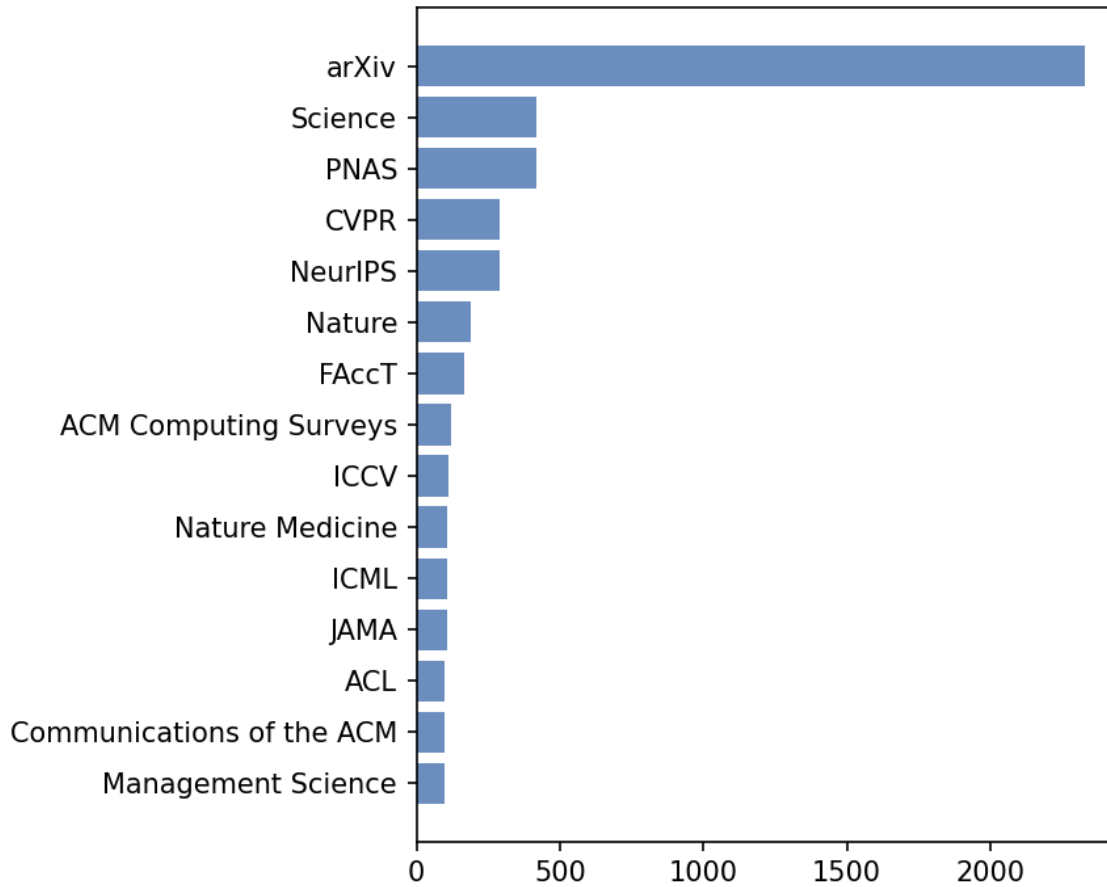


Reference years

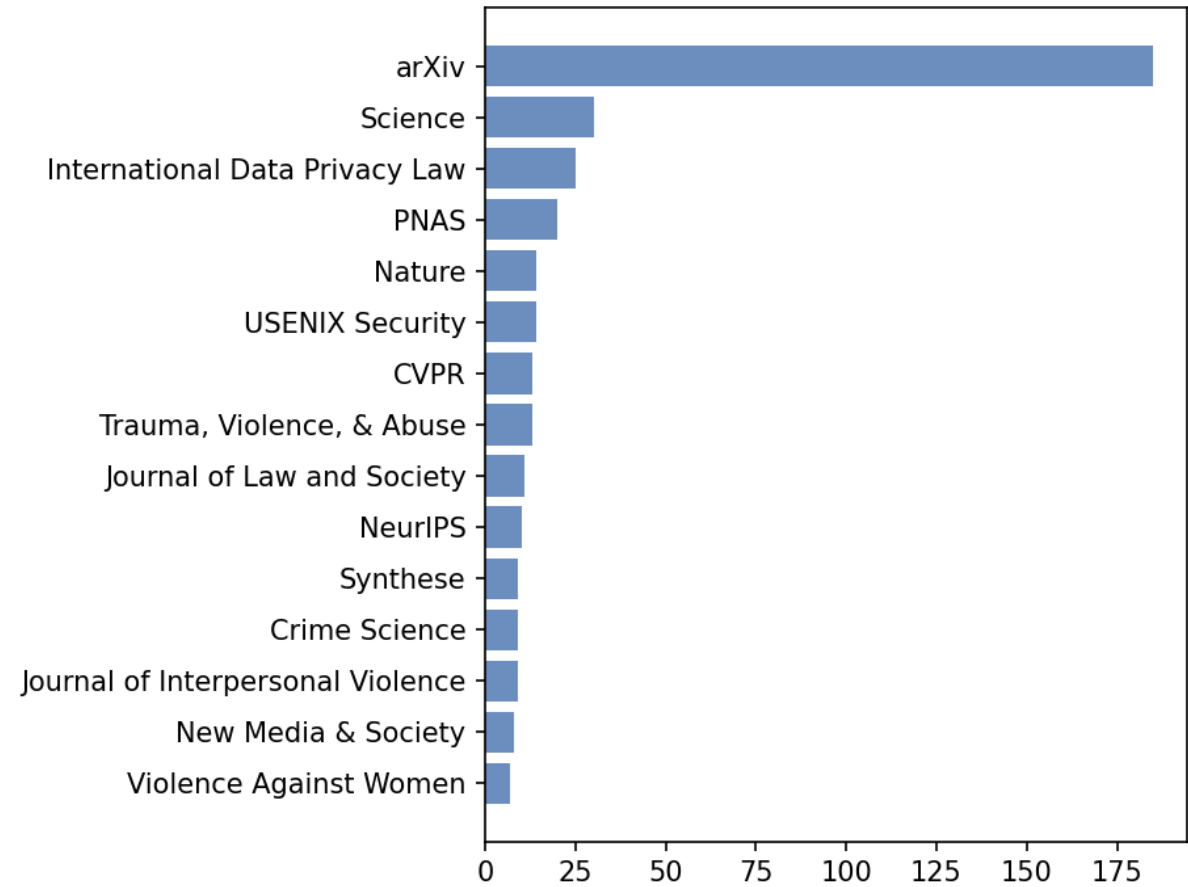


Top Publication Venues

Top venues: Democratic



Top venues: Republican



Wrap-Up

- Policymaking often requires technical expertise.
- Useful to be able to assess evidence in claims at scale.
- Preliminary evidence for effective pipeline using Gen AI tools.
- Substantial body of recent scientific evidence relevant to AI policy debates
- Next steps:
 - Validation
 - More validation!
 - Extension to other policy domains
 - For/against (stance) classification

Thank You!
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